No. 15

British Consulate for Taiwan
Taiwanfoo, 12th July 1874.

My Lord,

I have the honour to enclose copies of

(1) My Desp. No. 14 of this date to Mr. Wade :- No. 1.

(2) The despatch (and annex) from Taoutai which forms inclosure in the above, (in English only) :- 2.

All having relation to the Japanese expedition to Formosa.

I have the honour to be,

My Lord,

Your Lordship's most obedient humble Servant,

Consul Opps.

The Right Honourable
Lord Tenterden,
&c- &c- &c
Foreign Office
London

The National Archives' reference FO 17/686

Mr. W. Gregory
No. 15.
Two Inclosures

Rec^d. Sept: 21.

Japanese Expedition :-
Sends Copy of desp. to Mr. Wade with translation of Despatch from Imperial Commissioner to Japanese General, &c.

The Queen
& Rt Disraeli
Circulate

D

British Consulate for Taiwan,
Taiwanfoo, 12th July 1874.

Copy

No 14.

Sir,

In regard to the Japanese expedition:- I have the honour to send herewith copy and translation of a despatch from the Taoutai, dated the 4th Instant, conveying copy of a despatch from the Chinese Imperial Commissioner to the Japanese General. Your obedient servant

(Signed) Wm Gregory
Consul Officiating

F. Wade Esq C.B.
H.B.M. Envoy
Extraordinary,
&c &c &c.
Peking.

true copy,
F. L. Bullock

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Mr Gregory
to
Mr Wade

Enclosure
No 1.

In Mr Gregory's
No 15.
of 12th July 1874.

Translation

From Hia, Taoutai of Taiwan, &c. &c.
to Mr Gregory H. B. M. Consul at
Taiwan, &c. &c.

Date 4th July 1874.
(Tung chi, 13. 5. 21.)
(Received 4th July 1874.)

On the 1st of July I was
honoured with a communication
from the high officer Shih, —
Imperial Commissioner for the
Maritime Defences of Formosa
and for Foreign Affairs in the
same; - saying as follows: —

"As regards the communication
"which I have addressed to the
"Japanese General Saigo, it is right
"that I should send you herewith
"a copy made from the draft thereof;
soliciting

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"soliciting your attention, and
"requesting you to write word to the
"several foreign Consuls and to the
"Commissioners of Customs at the ports,
"for their information."

Having received the above, and its enclosure, I observe as follows.

The 1st Article of the New Treaty between China and Japan contains the following provision: "Henceforward "China and Japan shall observe a "redoubled friendship, endless as "heaven and earth. As regards the "territories subject to the two States, "each party shall observe the rules "of propriety, and shall abstain from "all encroachment and overstepping, "so that there may be endless peace "and quietness." — The Baw-tan or Mow-tan neighbourhood, although inhabited by wild aborigines, is in fact within the described limits of the Chinese Empire. Now that the Japanese, borrowing occasion from the earlier case of the shipwrecked Lew-chew people, have suddenly made an armed entry into the aborigines' villages; — what becomes of the provision against encroaching and overstepping?

I now send herewith a copy of the Imperial Commissioner Shên's despatch addressed to the Japanese General Saigo, and respectfully solicit your attention.

(Appended to the above)

(From the Imperial Commissioner to the Japanese General. — Date not given; but must be about the 20th of June 1874.

A communication.

The land of the wild aborigines has

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has belonged to China for more than two hundred years. The inhabitants though rude and ignorant, are produced by the Power above, and are like little babes. Therefore the Imperial Government has withheld itself from hastily bringing them under the rule of laws; and has desired that they should acquire benevolence by diffusion and righteousness by contact, should imperceptibly become civilised and gradually be reformed, should become from wild aborigines tame aborigines, and from tame — aborigines scholars and citizens. So would Heaven-implanted — benevolence be carried into practice.

That homicides must die, is plainly provided in the law; and though they be wild aborigines, they must not be lightly let pass. But the duty of dealing with such cases belongs to China. We must not trouble

trouble other states to come, to carrying their troops and expending their resources.

I hear that you, the honourable General, have suddenly brought soldiers in ships, and landed at Langkiaou, a place not open to foreign trade. The common people of Formosa, in alarm and doubt, have asked themselves what the offence may be [that is to be investigated, and] that has caused your country to regard the Treaty as of no account. The Western Treaty powers, too, all regard the news as alarming. Only on seeing your communication to the Viceroy of Fokien and Chekkiang, did we know that the cause was the slaughter, by the Bawlan — aborigines, of the wrecked Lew-chew people. Now, — apart from the fact that Lewchew, though it may be

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be weak, is still a State and can set forth its own grievances,- if Japan were bent upon being ~~a~~ compassionate [to a neighbouring State], why should not Japan have written to the Chinese Foreign Office and discussed the matter? And then, if China had screened the wild aborigines and replied that she would not chastise them, or if, her military power being ~~—~~ insufficient, she had borrowed aid from Japan, — in such case your honourable country would have had much to say for itself. But to heap up the old cases of several years, and then not to be able to wait a few days for a reply,- whether such proceedings as this be crooked or straight, be right or wrong,

wrong, is, I think, a point that can hardly escape your profound penetration.

Now the Bau-tan tribe in 281 territory having already been visited with fire and sword, you have ~~a~~ further extended the calamity to the unoffending Kaou-sze-fuh (Ko-soo-poot?) and other villages. What is the meaning, then, of the passage in your letter about "slaying the murderers"? What is the meaning of the passage about "assailing these people's minds"?

My coadjutor the Treasurer P'an had an interview at Shanghai with your honourable ~~—~~ country's Envoy, Lew-yuen (i.e. Yanagiwara); and obtained his consent to the withdrawal of the troops. I cannot suppose that these were empty words. Yet I hear, General, that you still have an encampment in the Bautan country. And further

there

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there is a rumour that you are about to attack the Pelam tribe.

Now the Bawlan are the slayers of shipwrecked Lewchew men, and the Pelam are the saviours of shipwrecked Japanese. Surely the two things are further from each other than sky from sod. To make a benefit into a cause of quarrel, – I think, honourable General, that such cannot be your way.

Something is said, however, in your despatch to the Viceroy of Tso-täng Li-pah having been robbed and plundered on his arrival at Pelam. I really suspect that this is an unfounded report, which is perhaps not without a cause.* Why! a man that has

Sworn

* Note. The suggestion may be that the report in question was got up by some party for a purpose.

Translator

sworn for his life, what property should he have left, to be robbed of? And what people in the world, that have robbed a man, will keep him and feed him for months, and take **no** payment for it? If it be said that the shipwrecked people's statements, as forwarded by the local Mandarins, are not sufficient evidence, – there is the letter of thanks from your honourable country, which contains not a word or hint of the robbery. The man Ch'in An-säng (Tan An-sing) to whom your country gave a reward, is the chief of the wild aborigines of Pelam. That the man who was rewarded should be the man to be smitten, – one need not suppose that such is the practice of your honourable Government.

People may say, perhaps, that Japan

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Japan is newly resplendent in military power, and is above being moved to awe by Heaven's reason, or to tender feelings by men's words. But with skilful commanders and vigorous troops, that have been for years under careful training, to wreak one's will upon utterly ~~a~~ ignorant wild aborigines, does not seem an adequate matter for the display of prowess. And if the completest victory be resolved upon [and obtained], still there will assuredly be slain and wounded on both sides. Though there be no pity for the wild aborigines, are your own people also unworthy of consideration?

Some may say again that your honourable country in extending hostilities to unoffending villages, has shown that its purpose is something different from the infliction of retribution. But, — apart from the fact that not a foot or an inch of Chinese territory can be given away to others, — there are the various States with whom we have intercourse, — is it likely that they would be content that Japan alone should get the advantage?

The southerly monsoon has begun to prevail, and it will now be increasingly difficult to make use of Lang-kiaou as a ~~a~~ place for landing stores.

The friendly relation between China and Japan is on record as a solemn covenant, a perpetual vow not to be forgotten. With danger present to my mind, how dare I refrain from telling it forth with sincerity? And so doing the one thing that a simple man can attain to?

Only

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Only let your lofty intelligence
Consider and examine, and
make me a reply. That will
be most happy.

M

The above is a necessary
Communication.

Translated by
Wm Gregory—

True copy
Ed Bullock—

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Taiwan Taotai
to
Consul Gregory

Enclosure
No. 2.

in Mr. Gregory's
No 15.

of 12th July 1874.